

TraceArt Murals

Paint stunning murals and window art by tracing a projection — no drawing talent required.

What It Is

A mural and window-painting service where you "cheat" the skill. You wear a VR/AR headset (or use a projector) that overlays a giant digital sketch directly onto the wall or window, then you simply paint along the projected outline like tracing. The result looks like a highly skilled custom artwork, but the process is far easier than it appears — so anyone can charge artist prices.

How It Makes Money

You sell custom hand-painted murals and seasonal window art to businesses and homeowners, billing by square foot or per project. Recurring revenue comes from seasonal window painting (holidays, sales events) that shops repaint multiple times a year, plus repeat commercial clients and referrals.

Startup Costs

- AR/VR headset for tracing/projection (or a quality projector): \$300–\$3,500 (a projector + laptop combo can start under \$400)
- Tracing/overlay app or software subscription: \$0–\$50/mo
- Paint, brushes, rollers, posca/paint markers, tape, drop cloths: \$300–\$700
- Ladder, scaffolding or extension poles: \$150–\$500
- Sealant/anti-graffiti coat for exterior murals: \$80–\$200
- LLC + general liability insurance: \$400–\$1,000
- Portfolio site/Shopify booking page + branding: \$300–\$700
- First-month local ads + sample window: \$300–\$700
- **Total to launch: \$1,500–\$6,000**

The Numbers

- Materials per small window mural: \$25–\$60; per large wall mural: \$150–\$400
- Window art price: \$200–\$600 per window
- Wall mural price: \$8–\$25 per sq ft → a 10x12 ft mural (120 sq ft) = \$1,500–\$3,000
- Profit per window job: \$150–\$550; per mural: \$1,200–\$2,600
- Do 3–4 window jobs/week + 2–3 murals/month = **\$8,000–\$18,000/month**, higher in holiday seasons.

How To Start

1. Get a headset or projector and practice tracing 2–3 designs on a garage wall until your linework is clean.
2. Build a portfolio by painting a free or discounted window for a local café or boutique and photographing it.
3. Set clear pricing (per window, per sq ft) and a simple booking page.
4. Buy quality paint markers and exterior-grade paint plus a UV/anti-graffiti sealer.
5. Form an LLC and get liability insurance (required to work on commercial storefronts).
6. Walk a busy retail street and pitch seasonal window art to 20 shops with photos of your sample.

7. Set seasonal reminders to re-pitch the same clients for each holiday repaint.

Where To Get Customers

Local retail storefronts, restaurants, cafés, and salons (seasonal windows); real-estate and event venues; schools and gyms wanting wall murals; Instagram and TikTok time-lapse paint videos; Google Local Service Ads for "mural artist near me"; referrals from satisfied shop owners on the same street.

Pro Tips

- Seasonal window art is the recurring goldmine — one retail block can become 10+ shops that repaint for every holiday, four to six times a year.
- Never reveal the headset/projection trick to clients; they're paying for the finished look and the convenience, not the method.
- Film clean time-lapses of every job — the "watch it appear" reel is your best ad and makes the skill look effortless and bookable.